

Spicy Chicken Quesadillas

with Beet & Orange Salad



A seasonal salad of striped Chioggia beet, juicy orange, and peanuts is a fresh pairing for these zesty quesadillas. We're seasoning the chicken filling with both jalapeño pepper and Mexican spices—balanced by a layer of melty white cheddar. Mexican crema brightened up with lime juice is perfect for dipping.

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4 Flour Tortillas

2 Scallions

6 oz Chioggia Beet

1 Jalapeño Pepper

1 Lime

1 Navel Orange

3 Tbsps Roasted Peanuts

2 oz White Cheddar Cheese

¼ cup Mexican Crema

**1 Tbsp Mexican Spice Blend (Ancho Chile Powder,
Smoked Paprika, Garlic Powder, Ground Cumin, &
Dried Mexican Oregano)**

tried-and-true

kitchen tools

[Stainless Steel Strainer](#)

A stainless steel strainer is a handy tool for quinoa. It's great for draining grains and pastas (not to mention small fruits and vegetables after washing) and straining stocks and gravy. Lightweight and sturdy, it's constructed with a double-fine mesh.



How To: Chop Scallions

Scallions, or green onions, are one of our favorite aromatic vegetables. There are two parts of the vegetable: the white bottom and the green top. They're used a little differently in cooking—the white bottoms are similar in use to regular onions and are usually cooked; the green tops are often used raw as a garnish. In our recipes, we specify to separate them. Check out this video to see how we do it.



1 Prepare & cook the beet:

Heat a small pot of salted water to boiling on high. Wash and dry the fresh produce. Peel the **beet** and cut lengthwise into 1/4-inch wedges. Once the pot of water is boiling, add the beet wedges and cook, uncovered, 22 to 24 minutes, or until tender when pierced with a fork. Drain and rinse under cold water for 30 seconds to 1 minute to stop the cooking process. Pat dry with paper towels and transfer to a large bowl.



2 Prepare the remaining ingredients:

While the beet cooks, cut off and discard the root ends of the **scallions**; thinly slice, separating the white bottoms and green tops. Using a peeler, remove the green rind of the **lime**, avoiding the white pith; mince to get 2 teaspoons of zest (or use a zester). Quarter the lime. Grate the **cheese** on the large side of a box grater. Peel the **orange**; halve lengthwise, then thinly slice crosswise. To make the lime crema, in a bowl, combine the **crema** and **the juice of 2 lime wedges**; season with salt and pepper to taste. Cut out and discard the stem, ribs, and seeds of the **pepper**; finely chop. Thoroughly wash your hands, knife, and cutting board immediately after handling the pepper.



3 Cook & chop the chicken:

While the beet continues to cook, pat the **chicken** dry with paper towels; season on both sides with salt, pepper, and the **spice blend**. In a large pan (nonstick, if you have one), heat 2 teaspoons of olive oil on medium-high until hot. Add the seasoned chicken; cook 3 to 4 minutes per side, or until browned and cooked through. Transfer to a cutting board; when cool enough to handle, roughly chop. Transfer to a medium bowl. Rinse and wipe out the pan.



4 Make the filling & assemble the quesadillas:

To the bowl of **chopped chicken**, add the **sliced white bottoms of the scallions**, **lime zest**, the **juice of 1 lime wedge**, a drizzle of olive oil, and **as much of the chopped pepper as you'd like**, depending on how spicy you'd like the dish to be. Stir to combine; season with salt and pepper to taste. Place the **tortillas** on a work surface. Sprinkle the **grated cheese** onto 1 side of each tortilla. Evenly top with the filling. Fold each tortilla in half over the filling.



5 Cook the quesadillas:

In the same pan, heat 2 teaspoons of olive oil on medium until hot. Add the **quesadillas**; cook 2 to 3 minutes per side, or until the tortillas are browned and the cheese has melted. (If the pan seems dry, add a drizzle of olive oil before flipping.) Transfer to a cutting board; immediately season with salt and pepper.



6 Make the salad & serve your dish:

While the quesadillas cook, add the **sliced orange, peanuts, the juice of the remaining lime wedge**, and a drizzle of olive oil to the bowl of **cooked beet**. Stir to combine; season with salt and pepper to taste. Cut the **cooked quesadillas** in half. Garnish the quesadillas and salad with the **sliced green tops of the scallions**. Serve with the **lime crema** on the side. Enjoy!